

The Troubleshooting Cheat Sheet

Quick fixes for the snags every new planner hits

Almost every digital planning problem has a thirty-second fix.
Here are the ones that come up most, sorted by where they happen.
Skim to your issue and you'll be back to planning in no time.

A QUICK NOTE ON APPS

This guide uses Goodnotes and Notability as examples since they're the most common. On Android or Windows? Samsung Notes, Xodo, and Notability's new Android app (in beta as of this year) all handle hyperlinked PDFs the same way - import the file, use the pen tool (not the selection tool) to write, and tap links in reading mode.

A FEW TERMS, EXPLAINED

Hyperlinked PDF - a PDF with clickable tabs/links built in, as opposed to a flat image.
Pen tool vs. Hand tool - pen writes, hand tool scrolls and taps links. Most navigation issues come from having the wrong one selected.
Layer - A separate level of the page; templates are usually locked so your writing doesn't move them

KEEP GOING

Still stuck? We're happy to help.
Email support@lilacdesk.com and we'll get you sorted. We love helping new digital planners succeed.

Category One
WRITING & THE PEN

Category Two
HYPERLINKS & NAVIGATION

Category Three
LOOK & QUALITY

Category Four
SAVING, SYNCING & DEVICES

Category Five
PRINTING & SHARING

CATEGORY ONE

Writing & Pen

Quick fixes for the snags every new planner hits

PROBLEM

MY HANDWRITING LOOKS MESSY ON SCREEN.

THE FIX

Completely normal for the first two to three weeks. Increase your pen thickness to 0.7mm and slow down slightly. Your digital handwriting improves faster than you think.

PROBLEM

I CAN'T WRITE ON MY PLANNER AT ALL

THE FIX

Your file most likely opened in a plain PDF viewer instead of your planner app. Import it into your annotation app (Goodnotes, Notability, Xodo, etc) then make sure the pen tool (not the hand/reading tool) is

PROBLEM

MY PALM KEEPS LEAVING MARKS

THE FIX

Turn on palm rejection in your app's settings, then rest your hand on the screen normally - it's designed to ignore it.

PROBLEM

MY STYLUS ISN'T BEING DETECTED AT ALL

THE FIX

Check your stylus is charged and paired (for Bluetooth pens) or seated properly (for passive styluses). Restart the app after reconnecting - most writing issues clear up after a fresh launch.

PROBLEM

EVERY LINE LOOKS THE SAME THICKNESS NO MATTER HOW HARD I PRESS

THE FIX

Pressure sensitivity needs to be turned on in your app's pen settings, and it only works with a pressure-sensitive stylus (Apple Pencil, S Pen) - a plain capacitive stylus won't do it.

PROBLEM

THERE'S A DELAY BETWEEN WRITING AND SEEING THE LINE APPEAR

THE FIX

Close other open apps running in the background and make sure your device's software is updated - lag is almost always a performance issue, not a planner issue.

CATEGORY TWO

Hyperlinks & Navigation

Quick fixes for the snags every new planner hits

PROBLEM

THE TABS WON'T JUMP BETWEEN PAGES

THE FIX

Tap the tab once - don't draw on it. If nothing happens, you're in editing mode; switch to reading (hand) mode. Also confirm you imported the original hyperlinked PDF, not a flattened copy.

PROBLEM

I CAN'T FIND THE FILE I IMPORTED

THE FIX

Check your app's main library or Documents view and search the planner's name. Make sure the import fully finished before you closed the app.

PROBLEM

MY PAGES ARE OUT OF ORDER

THE FIX

This happens when pages import separately. Re-import the original PDF as a single file, or open the page manager and drag the pages back into order.

PROBLEM

THE LINKS ON MY COVER PAGE OR TABLE OF CONTENTS DON'T WORK

THE FIX

Same fix as the tabs - you're likely in editing mode. Switch to the hand/reading tool, and confirm you imported the original file rather than a screenshot or flattened copy.

CATEGORY THREE

Look & Quality

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PROBLEM

THE PLANNER LOOKS BLURRY

THE FIX

Zoom to 100% before you judge it - screen previews often look soft. If it's genuinely low-resolution, re-download the original PDF and import it again.

PROBLEM

STICKER WON'T MOVE OR RESIZE

THE FIX

Select the sticker with the lasso tool first, then drag the corner handles. If it won't budge, it may be on a locked template layer - add it to a new layer or page instead.

PROBLEM

THE COLORS LOOK DIFFERENT THAN THEY DID ON THE PRODUCT PHOTOS

THE FIX

This is almost always your screen, not the file - brightness, dark mode, and color profile all shift how colors render. Turn off dark mode and check in daylight before comparing.

PROBLEM

MY PLANNER LOOKS STRETCHED, CROPPED, OR THE WRONG SHAPE

THE FIX

Your app may have auto-fit the page to a different aspect ratio. Look for an "original size" or "fit to page" import setting and choose the one that preserves the file's actual dimensions.

CATEGORY FOUR

Saving, Syncing, & Devices

Quick fixes for the snags every new planner hits

PROBLEM

SHOULD I CUSTOMIZE THE ORIGINAL FILE DIRECTLY?

THE FIX

No - duplicate it first and customize the copy. That way you always have a clean original to fall back to if something goes wrong.

PROBLEM

THE APP CRASHED AND I LOST MY WORK

THE FIX

Most apps auto-save every few seconds. Reopen it and check your recent file, or look for recovery files in the app's settings.

PROBLEM

MY PLANS AREN'T SYNCING ACROSS DEVICES

THE FIX

Confirm cloud sync is switched on and that you're signed into the same account on both devices. Give it a minute on Wi-Fi to catch up.

PROBLEM

I LOST OR REPLACED MY DEVICE

THE FIX

As long as your cloud sync was on, just reinstall the app on your new device and sign in - your files should come right back.

PROBLEM

MY STORAGE IS FULL AND THE IMPORT WON'T FINISH

THE FIX

Free up space on your device or in your cloud account before re-importing - a partial import is the most common cause of missing or out-of-order pages.

PROBLEM

THE APP WON'T OPEN AT ALL

THE FIX

Restart your device first - it fixed more than you'd expect. If that doesn't work, check the app store for a pending update.

CATEGORY FIVE

Printing & Sharing

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PROBLEM

I WANT TO PRINT A PAGE

THE FIX

Export the page as a PDF, then print at 100% or “actual size” on A4 or US Letter for a clean result.

PROBLEM

I WANT TO SHARE MY PLANS WITH FAMILY

THE FIX

Export the pages as a PDF or image, or share the whole file through a cloud link.

PROBLEM

MY PRINTED PAGE IS CUTTING OFF CONTENT AT THE EDGES

THE FIX

Turn off “fit to page” or “scale to fit” in your settings and print at 100%/actual size instead - scaling is almost always the cause of the crop.

PROBLEM

CAN I SHARE THESE PLANNERS WITH OTHERS?

THE FIX

These are for your personal use - please do not redistribute or resell these files. Sharing your own filled-in pages with family or on social media is totally fine.